

STATS AND FACTS

A large number of finger bones tightly arranged in rows gave *Platypterygius*'s oversized flippers a broad, flat appearance. This unusual feature earned the creature its name, which means "flat wing" in Greek.

SKULL



Fossils suggest that *Platypterygius* had a large skull about 4 ft (1.2 m) long.

EYESIGHT



Scientists think that *Platypterygius* couldn't hear very well, so it relied on its strong eyesight for hunting.

Platypterygius's large dorsal fin kept it stable while swimming.

The upper tail lobe of this creature, which was not attached to the spine, was made of strong cartilage.

Platypterygius's lower tail lobe was supported by the end of the spinal column.

The creature's back limbs were much smaller than its front flippers.

Like all ichthyosaurs, *Platypterygius* gave birth to live young.

AT A GLANCE

LENGTH 23 ft (7 m)

DIET Fish and small marine reptiles

LIVED 125-90 MYA

HABITAT Oceans

